



January 2, 2026

United States Citizenship and Immigration Services

Re: Letter of Support for Mr. Vivek Mishra's EB-2 NIW Petition

Dear USCIS Officer:

My name is Dr. Zhenyu Wang, and I am a Senior Research Associate at the Center for Urban Transportation Research (CUTR) at the University of South Florida (USF). I am pleased to offer my independent professional evaluation and strong support for Mr. Vivek Mishra's EB-2 National Interest Waiver (NIW) petition.

I am a researcher with a professional background in transportation engineering, data-driven mobility systems, and infrastructure resilience. For approximately fifteen years, my work at CUTR has concentrated on leveraging advanced data analytics and simulation methodologies to enhance transportation safety, efficiency, and sustainability, often in collaboration with federal and state agencies. This position provides me with direct insight into the significant challenges confronting U.S. infrastructure and the critical imperative for innovation.

My testimony is rendered in the capacity of an independent expert. I have no personal acquaintance with Mr. Mishra, nor have we ever collaborated on any work. My initial familiarity with his research began in early 2021 during my own research activities. While investigating new optimization models for public mobility, I came across his published study on AI-assisted transportation systems. His work immediately distinguished itself by its practical applicability and direct relevance to the problems we endeavor to resolve in the United States. His research has subsequently influenced multiple studies conducted at CUTR, focusing on data-driven decision-making and equitable access in transportation.

In my specialized field, the United States faces a critical predicament: our public transportation infrastructure is aging, inefficient, and plagued by persistent funding and equity gaps. The fundamental challenge has progressed beyond merely constructing asphalt or rail lines; it is now centered on *intelligently utilizing* the existing systems. This necessitates a novel, interdisciplinary skill set capable of effectively bridging the divide between traditional civil engineering and advanced artificial intelligence. This precise skill set is scarce, and it is demonstrably the domain where Mr. Mishra has established his expertise.

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Mr. Mishra's body of work presents a direct and potent solution to this challenge. He has successfully developed and published novel frameworks that empower public agencies to make previously unattainable data-driven decisions. For instance, his research on automated traffic modeling and multimodal optimization, particularly in projects associated with Caltrans, provides a straightforward methodology for evaluating complex infrastructure investments. He has demonstrated the practical application of machine learning and data fusion to predict the economic and safety benefits of specific projects, thereby transitioning transportation planning from an estimation-based model to a data-driven, evidence-based approach.

The profound significance of this contribution cannot be overstated. His methods enable agencies to evaluate investments, simulate future mobility requirements, and address systemic congestion and access deficiencies with notably greater efficiency. His research, in particular, focuses on equitable transport access and provides a quantitative framework for identifying and rectifying service gaps within underserved communities, a paramount objective for the U.S. Department of Transportation. His work effectively translates complex academic research into tangible, real-world policy execution.

While his research output is substantial, Mr. Mishra's professional standing is further validated by his role in evaluating his peers' work. His service as a paper reviewer for premier international AI conferences, such as NeurIPS and ICLR, and his position in assessing applications for IEEE Senior Member elevation, are highly significant. These are not merely titular roles; they represent positions of trust that affirm that other senior experts in his discipline rely upon his technical judgment to validate new and vital scholarly contributions.

Based upon my independent review of his professional portfolio, I would characterize Mr. Vivek Mishra as one of the most promising emerging researchers operating at the nexus of artificial intelligence and transportation engineering. His work has garnered international recognition and already influenced government-funded programs in the U.S.

Mr. Mishra's interdisciplinary proficiency in data analytics and AI is precisely the capability required for our national infrastructure modernization efforts. His skills are in exceptionally high demand and are exceedingly difficult to source. I offer my unequivocal support for the approval of his petition.

Sincerely,



1/4/2026

X *Zhenyu Wang*

Zhenyu Wang

Senior Research Faculty

Signed by: localhost

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